weeks; and were very sickly. Their straw on the stone floor almost worn to dust. Long confinement, and not having the king's allowance of 2s. 6d. a week, had urged them to attempt an escape: after which the gaoler chained them as above. There is another dungeon for women felons twelve feet by eight; and upstairs a separate room or two.

The common-side debtors in the low gaol, whom I saw eating boiled bread and water, told me, that this was the only nourishment some had lived upon for nearly a twelvemonth. They have from a legacy one shilling and sixpence a week in winter, and one shilling a week in summer for coals. No memorandum of it in the gaol; perhaps this may in time be lost, as the gaoler said two others were, viz. one of Bishop Crewe, and another of Bishop Wood; from which, prisoners had received no benefit for some years past. But now the Bishop has humanely filed bills in chancery and recovered these legacies, by which several debtors have been discharged. Half a crown a week is paid to a woman for supplying the debtors with water, in the two rooms on the side of the gateway. The Act for preserving the health of prisoners not hung up. The clauses against spirituous liquors are hung up. Gaol delivery once a year. At several of my visits there were boys between thirteen and fifteen years of age, confined with the most profligate and abandoned.

There was a vacant piece of ground adjacent, of little use but for the gaoler's occasional lumber. It extends to the river, and measures about twenty-two yards by sixteen. I once and again advised the enclosing this for a court: as it might be done with little expense, and it appears that formerly here was a doorway into the prison: but when I was there in January 1776, I had the mortification to hear that the surgeon, who was uncle to the gaoler, had obtained from the Bishop, in October preceding, a lease of it for twenty-one years, at the rent of one shilling per annum. He had built a little stable on it.

NORTHUMBERLAND

NEWCASTLE

In this Newgate, which is the gate at the upper end of the town, all the rooms except the condemned room are upstairs, and airy: I always found them remarkably clean, strewed with sand, etc. The corporation allow both debtors and felons

firing and candles in plenty: and every prisoner has a chaff bed, two blankets, and a coverlet: debtors and felons are thus accommodated in few other prisons in England. They also allow brooms, mops, and all such necessaries. The sums generously allowed for those articles, amount to £40 12s. 8d. per annum. This is one of the very few gaols that have what is called in London the rules. Part of two streets near the gaol is in the prison-liberty.

COUNTY GAOL AT MORPETH

The debtors have six sizable rooms which are out of repair, and a free ward called the middle tower. Some commodious rooms lately built are occupied by the gaoler. Only one court, which is for debtors. Felons are always shut up in the tower. In the women's room I saw (January 1776) two; who, the gaoler said, were cast for transportation; one in September 1773, the other in November 1774: but at my visit in 1779, I found they had been humanely released at the assize.

Of the other two rooms, generally appropriated to men felons, one is a day-room (fourteen feet two inches by six feet nine), the other an offensive dungeon, the window only eighteen inches by nine. In the latter were three transports (1776) who, upon suspicion of intending an escape, were chained to the floor. They had not the king's allowance of 2s. 6d. a week.

Gaol delivery once a year. Assize held at Newcastle, whither prisoners are conveyed; and men and women confined together seven or eight nights in a dirty damp dungeon down six steps in the old castle, which having no roof, in a wet season the water is some inches deep. The felons are chained to rings in the wall.

The county for some years paid the gaoler's fees for acquitted prisoners, if poor: and clothed such transports as were quite indigent.

CUMBERLAND

COUNTY GAOL AT CARLISLE

The court spacious, eighty-five yards by thirty-six: it was common to all prisoners; but now a part is appropriated to the felons, and separated by iron palisades. In the court is a chapel, built, as appears by the date, in 1734. Five rooms for master's-side debtors: and as many on the common-side.